public policy head for India, South Asia and Central Asia of ensuring that posts by some BJP leaders—flagged as hate speech by Facebook's community guidelines team (which is supposed to ensure that posts on the platform follow certain minimum standards)—were not removed. This was allegedly done, according to the *WSJ*, because it was felt that such actions would anger the ruling government. Facebook's public policy officials also wrote internal messages, according to the report, supporting the BJP and its political triumphs, and disparaging its main political rival.[28] While Facebook denied any inappropriate bias, the BJP government hit back, accusing the company of bias against the ruling party. The then Union IT Minister Ravi Shankar Prasad wrote to Facebook CEO Mark Zuckerberg that the 'Facebook India team, right from the India Managing Director to other senior officials, is dominated by people who belong to a particular political belief.' He argued that the Facebook India management had deleted some pages run by people sympathetic to 'right-of-centre ideology' or reduced their reach on its platform before the 2019 general election.[29] There was an echo here of how, in the US, Facebook refused to flag as fake news a statement by US President Donald Trump, even though other tech platforms like Twitter had done so.[30] The final word on this issue is yet to be written—one man's hate speech is another man's freedom of speech, as the BJP has argued—but the political battles around such judgement calls illustrate the highly contested nature of the digital space that Indian politics now operates in.[31]

'The Internet Hindu' and Digital Politics: BJP Leads but Congress Is Not a Write-Off

'Internet Hindus are like swarms of bees,' tweeted the TV journalist Sagarika Ghose in 2010. 'They come swarming after you at any mention of Modi, Muslims or Pakistan.'[32] This was possibly the first articulation of the idea of the Cyber Hindu and the dominance of the political right-wing online. It's not simply about troll armies or the daily vitriolic battles that are fought on Twitter. The Times Group's mega 'Pulse of the Nation' e-poll in May 2018, which asked users